



Case Study: Evaluation of Enterprise Architecture of a Media Company

Estimated reading time: 15 minutes

Introduction

In today's digital-first environment, media companies face significant pressure to adapt to rapidly changing consumer preferences, new delivery platforms, and evolving content production technologies. The enterprise architecture (EA) of a media company plays a significant role in facilitating these changes.

This case study evaluates the EA of a hypothetical media company, MediaTech, which engages in content production, distribution, and monetization across multiple platforms. The evaluation reviews MediaTech's existing EA framework, identifies challenges, and recommends improvements that align with the company's strategic goals.

Objectives

After completing this reading, you will be able to:

- Describe the core business and current IT landscape of the MediaTech company
- Identify the five key domains for evaluating the enterprise architecture (EA) framework and explain the strengths and weaknesses of each
- Identify the critical challenges of the Mediatech company based on the evaluation of its EA framework
- Describe the proposed improvements to address the identified challenges

Background of the MediaTech company

Company overview

MediaTech is a mid-sized media company with operations across TV, digital streaming, social media platforms, and print publications. Its core business

includes:

- **Content creation:** Producing original films, TV shows, and digital media
- **Content distribution:** Delivering content via Over-the-Top (OTT) streaming platforms, cable TV, and social media
- **Advertising and monetization:** Generating revenue through advertising, subscriptions, and syndication deals

Current IT landscape of the company

The current IT landscape presents several challenges that hinder operational efficiency and scalability. These issues include:

- **Data silos:** Separate databases for production, distribution, and monetization systems
- **Legacy systems:** Relies on outdated ERP software for resource planning and billing
- **Fragmented cloud adoption:** Inconsistent use of cloud services across departments
- **Manual workflows:** Inefficient manual processes for content tagging, metadata management, and distribution scheduling

Evaluation framework

The EA framework is evaluated across five key domains: business architecture, data architecture, application architecture, technology architecture, and security architecture. The following section describes the strengths and weaknesses of each of these domains.

Business architecture

The business architecture focuses on the alignment of IT systems with MediaTech's operational and strategic objectives.

- **Strengths:**
 - Provides a clear understanding of customer needs for multiplatform content consumption
 - Helps establish partnerships with distribution networks and advertisers
- **Weaknesses:**
 - Lack of integration between production, distribution, and monetization workflows, resulting in delays and inefficiencies
 - Ineffective resource allocation due to the absence of predictive analytics capabilities

Data architecture

Data architecture defines how MediaTech manages its vast volumes of content, consumer data, and analytics.

- **Strengths:**
 - Utilizes rich metadata from content and customer interaction records
 - Gains access to detailed viewer engagement metrics via streaming platforms
- **Weaknesses:**
 - Data silos prevent holistic insights into customer preferences and content performance
 - Inconsistent data governance, leading to inaccuracies in reporting
 - Limited use of real-time data analytics for decision-making

Application architecture

The application architecture involves the design and interconnectivity of software systems supporting MediaTech's operations.

- **Strengths:**
 - Employs proprietary content production tools with high functionality
 - Maintains separate systems for ad placement and content licensing contracts
- **Weaknesses:**
 - Lack of integration between applications, leading to duplicate data entry
 - Dependence on monolithic systems, limiting scalability and flexibility
 - Absence of automation in repetitive workflows such as content distribution scheduling

Technology architecture

The technology architecture evaluates the underlying infrastructure supporting MediaTech's operations.

- **Strengths:**
 - Implements high-capacity servers for content storage and streaming
 - Uses cloud platforms for video transcoding and storage
- **Weaknesses:**
 - Fragmented cloud adoption, with varying providers and no centralized management
 - Legacy hardware in on-premises data centers, increasing maintenance costs
 - Limited support for emerging technologies such as AI-driven content curation

Security architecture

The security architecture ensures the protection of MediaTech's sensitive data, content, and customer information.

- **Strengths:**
 - Uses Digital Rights Management (DRM) systems for content protection
 - Ensures basic firewalls and access control measures are in place
- **Weaknesses:**
 - Gaps in cybersecurity protocols, such as insufficient encryption for customer data
 - Limited incident response planning for data breaches
 - Over-reliance on manual processes for user access management

Identified challenges

Based on the evaluation of the organization's EA framework, the following critical challenges are identified:

- **Operational silos:** Fragmented systems impede collaboration across departments
- **Scalability issues:** Legacy infrastructure and monolithic applications limit the ability to scale operations
- **Inefficient workflows:** Manual processes slow down content tagging, distribution, and monetization
- **Data governance gaps:** Lack of a unified data governance framework hinders accuracy and compliance
- **Security vulnerabilities:** Outdated security practices expose the organization to data breaches

Proposed improvements

To address the identified challenges and enhance operational efficiency, the following proposed improvements are recommended:

- **1. Unified EA framework**
 - Implement a centralized EA framework that integrates business, data, and technology domains.
- **2. Adoption of a data mesh approach**
 - Break down silos by implementing a data mesh framework to enable decentralized data management. This will facilitate better collaboration and real-time analytics.
- **3. Migration to cloud-native architectures**

- Replace legacy systems with microservices-based cloud-native applications
- Standardize cloud adoption across departments to optimize costs and improve efficiency
- **4. Automation and AI integration**
 - Automate repetitive workflows such as metadata tagging and content scheduling using AI-driven tools
 - Leverage AI to personalize content recommendations and optimize advertisement placements
- **5. Strengthening security measures**
 - Deploy advanced encryption protocols and endpoint security tools
 - Implement centralized identity and access management systems
 - Develop a robust incident response plan for cybersecurity threats

Summary

MediaTech, a mid-sized media organization, was facing challenges such as data silos, legacy systems, and inefficient workflows. To address these challenges, certain improvements are proposed that include adopting a unified enterprise architecture, implementing a data mesh, migrating to cloud-native systems, automating workflows with AI, and strengthening security measures to align with strategic goals.